

application wants to use the Bluetooth connected to the laptop to send data to another device, they can use the same library.

/media: Although this directory isn't a part and parcel of Linux, it is usually the place where you'll find your USB drives and cameras get mounted under Linux when you connect them. We hope you remember the concept of mounting we showed just a few hundred words ago.

/mnt: This too is a directory which doesn't contain anything important by default, but in most cases is used to create mount points for other file systems which are attached to the computer on boot, e.g. Windows partitions.

/opt: The directory is used to install optional software packages. For example, if you were to install Google Earth for Linux, it would be installed within this directory. \

/proc: The directory is freely available for browsing only to the 'root' user. This directory contains files and directories which explain the state of the system. The directory doesn't consume any space on disk. It's a virtual directory that exists only in the system memory. Remember that the master administrator account of Linux is called the 'root' user.

/sbin: It is here that you'd find the commands to change system-wide settings (read: administration). This one, once again, is a property of root user. No trespassing, please!

/sys: It contains the files related to the PnP facility under Linux (including Ubuntu)

/tmp: It is THE temporary directory for Linux. While Windows has a split personality when it comes to 'temporary directory' thoughts, Linux maintains its personality by keeping every tmp file in the tmp directory.

/usr: You can call it the program files folder of Linux. The /usr directory also contains some other system-wide elements (in addition to programs) such as wallpapers, themes and a few libraries which are installed as part of software installations.

/var: The name suggests its contents. The files in this folder are mostly those which change often. It includes the webroot directories, databases and a few similar things. Do remember however that it is not to be removed.

Of all the mentioned directories, the /home directory is where you'll find yourself storing everything (unless you've mounted other partitions with right permissions) mainly because of permission restrictions imposed by Ubuntu Linux. 